

AS2050* Aerodynamics

Course Policies and Expectations

3rd Semester (July–November 2026) • B Slot

Instructor: Pradeep Kumar Seshadri • Department of Aerospace Engineering, IIT Madras

Grading Breakdown

Component	Description	Weight
Continuous Assessment	A short quiz at every tutorial (may cover lectures, an assigned reading, or both), plus any assignments announced during the term. First quiz ungraded; lowest three graded quizzes dropped.	20%
Software Exercise	Individual. Use of aerodynamics software to produce results, plots, and their interpretation.	5%
Group Presentation	Group. A real-world aerodynamics topic; strictly 15 minutes (12 present + 3 Q&A).	5%
Quiz 1	Tuesday, 1 September 2026. Covers material taught up to that point.	15%
Quiz 2	Tuesday, 6 October 2026. Covers material taught between Quiz 1 and Quiz 2.	15%
End-Semester Exam	Friday, 13 November 2026. Comprehensive; covers the entire course.	40%
Total		100%

There is no separate professionalism/participation grade this semester. Constructive conduct is expected of everyone and is described under Classroom Conduct below.

Continuous Assessment (20%)

This component is built through the term, principally from a **short in-class quiz at every tutorial**, together with any assignments announced during the term. The rules:

- There is a short, closed-book quiz at **each tutorial**. A quiz may draw on the recent lectures, an **assigned reading**, or both.
- Reading assignments are announced on the **preceding Friday**, giving you the weekend and the following days to prepare.
- The **first tutorial quiz is ungraded** — a no-stakes run so you learn the format.
- Your **lowest three graded quizzes are dropped**. This is also your absence allowance: **you may miss up to three tutorials** with no penalty, since a missed quiz simply becomes one of your three dropped scores. **There is no make-up for a tutorial quiz.**
- The weight of any item is fixed and communicated **before** it is assessed; nothing is re-weighted after the fact.

Software Exercise (5%) and Group Presentation (5%)

Software Exercise (individual). You will use standard aerodynamics software to compute a result, produce plots, and *interpret* them in your own words. Credit is for the interpretation, not merely for generating output.

Group Presentation (group). Each group presents a real-world aerodynamics topic in a **strict 15-minute slot (12 minutes of presentation + 3 minutes of questions)**. Timing is part of the assessment. A rubric will be shared in advance.

Assignment and Submission Policy

1. Assignments carry a **10% penalty per late day, up to 3 days**.
2. After 3 days: **no credit** unless excused via formal documentation.
3. Extensions must be **requested via official email**, not in class or over messaging.

Use of AI Tools

AI tools may be genuinely useful for learning; they are also easy to misuse. This course draws a clear line by *where* work is done, not by pretending AI does not exist:

- **Supervised work** — tutorial quizzes, Quiz 1, Quiz 2, and the End-Semester Exam: **no AI tools**. These carry the majority of the grade and test what you can do yourself.
- **Assignments and the software exercise:** AI tools are **permitted as a supplement**. If you use one, you must (i) show your own initial attempt and reasoning, (ii) include the exact prompts and the response you relied on, and (iii) state what you verified, corrected, or learned. Credit reflects **how thoughtfully you engaged and how carefully you checked the output** — not whether AI was used.
- Pasting an AI answer without engagement, or presenting unverified AI output as your own work, is treated as dishonest use and penalised.

Academic Integrity

Violations (plagiarism, copying, dishonest use of AI tools, collusion) will result in (1) zero marks on the task, and (2) reporting to the Institute per the academic honesty policy.

Make-up Exam Policy

Only **one make-up exam** will be conducted, **after the End-Semester Exam**. A student may miss **any one** of: Quiz 1, Quiz 2, or the End-Semester Exam. The make-up exam:

1. Covers the **entire syllabus**;
2. Is **more conceptually rigorous**;
3. Is the **only** make-up opportunity (no separate papers per component);
4. Requires notification via official email **before** the missed exam.

Students missing more than one exam will rely on the remaining evaluation components.

Communication and Requests

All formal requests (extensions, make-up exams, regrades) must (1) be sent from your institute email ID, (2) carry a clear subject line, (3) attach supporting documentation if applicable, and (4) be submitted before the deadline where possible. Verbal requests or messages over informal

channels will not be accepted.

Classroom Conduct

No longer a graded component, but the class runs on it: be attentive and present; contribute to discussions and group work; submit on time and respond to communications. Disruption, or presenting unverified/AI-copied work as your own, is treated under the policies above.

Devices. At the start of each class, silence your phone and place it face-down. Laptops and tablets are not used in lecture unless the activity requires it. Students with a genuine emergency need should inform the instructor in advance.

Inclusivity, Support and Equal Opportunity

Students come from diverse backgrounds and may face different challenges. If you are having difficulty keeping up or need clarification, email me from your official ID to request a confidential, judgment-free one-on-one discussion. The goal is a fair opportunity to succeed for everyone. If in doubt about anything, communicate early through the proper channel.